



Separation Support

Premium practice worksheet

SEPARATION SUPPORT - LESSON 02

Find the real starting point before you train.

This worksheet helps owners identify the dog's easiest successful starting duration and organize the training setup before beginning a departure plan.

TRAINER NOTE

Your baseline is not the longest time your dog can survive. It is the longest time your dog can stay genuinely comfortable.

START HERE

Dog: _____

Date: _____

Owner: _____

Best reward: _____

1 What success looks like

By the end of this lesson, the owner has a baseline duration their dog can handle calmly and understands which setup makes success most likely.

2 Practice plan

1

Test very small absences

Start with a few seconds and watch whether your dog remains organized and calm.

2

Score body language honestly

Notice relaxed posture, mild concern, pacing, vocalizing, or panic signs.

3

Repeat the successful rep

Use the longest easy duration your dog can handle calmly three times in a row.

4

Write down the baseline

Choose that safe duration as your starting point for future practice.



Separation Support

Alone-Time Assessment

3 Supplies and setup

Supplies needed

- ☐ Phone or camera
- ☐ Safe confinement setup or room
- ☐ Chew or enrichment item if appropriate
- ☐ Simple duration log

Set up before you start

- ☐ Meet exercise, potty, and comfort needs first.
- ☐ Use the easiest departure setup available.
- ☐ Begin with tiny test absences and return before stress appears.

4 Baseline assessment tracker

Date	Setup	Absence	Body language	Returned before stress?	Notes?

5 5-day practice micro plan

Day 1

Set baseline

Find the easiest version and keep it calm.

Day 2

Repeat wins

Practice the same setup until it looks smooth.

Day 3

Add one tiny step

Add only one small challenge if yesterday

Day 4

Hold or simplify

If your puppy struggled, make today easier.

Day 5

Review notes

Choose the safest next step from your log.



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Alone-Time Assessment

6 Common mistakes and quick fixes

Common mistakes

- Jumping from seconds to minutes too quickly.
- Calling the assessment a failure because the dog looked mildly unsure.
- Increasing time after only one good rep.
- Practicing when the dog is already tired, wired, or under-stimulated.

If this happens, try this

- If the dog shows stress immediately, simplify the setup and reduce the duration.
- If the dog only stays calm with a chew, note that support and use it intentionally.
- If the dog cannot recover, stop increasing time and seek guidance.

7 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I know my dog's easiest setup for alone-time practice.
- ☐ I have a baseline duration.
- ☐ I am scoring body language rather than just counting seconds.
- ☐ I know what would make the next rep easier if needed.

HOMEWORK

Test short absences over several days and identify the longest duration your dog handled calmly at least three times in a row.

8 Owner reflection

Biggest win: _____

What made it easier: _____

What should I repeat tomorrow: _____

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR FITDOG TRAINER

What should I make easier? _____

What should I practice again? _____

What is the next realistic step? _____